

proportion of men entered military service during the Civil War than in World War II, and the death rate was six times higher.

During the 19th century, in an era of imperfect medicine and unskilled practitioners, disease was the greater scourge—accounting for roughly two-thirds of those who perished. Though hundreds of thousands of soldiers survived their injuries, untold numbers suffered throughout the rest of their lives. Amputation was a common surgical remedy for seriously wounded limbs. The Union's multivolume *Medical and Surgical History of the War of the Rebellion* tabulated 30,000 reported amputations on Union soldiers alone, giving details of thousands of surgical cases. However, despite recording all this data, medical services on both sides did not understand the connection between combat and mental trauma. Large numbers of veterans were haunted for years by the horrific memories of war—afflicted by what is today known as post-traumatic stress disorder.



The Union dead

During the assault on Charleston, South Carolina, the 3rd New Hampshire Infantry was based at Hilton Head Island. Many fell victim to disease and were buried in primitive graves in the Union cemetery.